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sudo apt-get install deja-dup
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The latest version of Déjà Dup appears as *Backup* in menus. In Ubuntu, Déjà Dup can be opened from the *System Settings* window. Figure 1 shows the start screen of Déjà Dup in Debian and Figure 2 shows the same in Ubuntu.

Taking backups with Déjà Dup

This is very simple and can be done by performing the following basic steps:

1. Select the *folders* to be preserved in the *Folders* tab. Also choose which sub-folders are to be ignored.
2. Select the destination (i.e., where the backups are kept) in the *Storage* tab.
3. You can set a *schedule* in the *Schedule* tab, which takes effect only if you enable *Automatic backups* in the *Overview* tab.
4. Click the *Back Up Now* button in the *Overview* tab. You may now be prompted to set a password.

The *Folders to ignore* facility is highly useful in case you have to take the backup of a master directory, excluding some junk or bulk content inside it. The classic example is to take the backup of your home folder, excluding *Trash* and *Downloads*.

To test the use of Déjà Dup, please choose a lightweight folder in Step 1, select a *Local Folder* (e.g., */tmp*) in Step 2, and go on.

If you are taking an important backup, you may choose an external disk as the *Backup location*. We'll look at an example for remote storage right after checking how to restore backups using Déjà Dup.

Restoring backups with Déjà Dup

The general process is somewhat as follows:

1. Click *Restore...* in the *Overview* tab.
2. Choose *Restore* from the newly-appeared dialogue box and click *Forward*. If you are storing backups in a single location, you have to change nothing here.
3. Déjà Dup asks for a password if you are storing your backups in a password-protected area (especially an FTP server). Give it and move on.
4. Now Déjà Dup asks for a restore point, i.e., the exact moment from when to restore. Choose a date/timestamp and go forward.
5. The next frame asks for a location to restore the backup. You can choose the original location or an alternative folder. The first option is best if you accidentally deleted a folder. Go on with the wizard.
6. Now you will be asked for the encryption password (if any). This is the password you used to encrypt your files while taking a backup. Give it and the restoration works.

Déjà Dup online backups

Déjà Dup supports many remote storage services. The new version supports Amazon S3 and Rackspace Cloud Files, in

addition to the standard remote storage methods. Here we are going to experiment with the classic FTP storage. In order to perform this, you need an FTP account. I am using my FTP account in the website that I own.

Here are the steps:

1. Choose the *folders* in the *Folders* tab. Give your FTP account details in the *Storage* tab after selecting FTP from the *Storage location* combo box (Figure 3). Details about the server and port can be obtained from your service provider or Web hosting control panel. In my case, as I own *nandakumar.co.in*, the server is *ftp.nandakumar.co.in* and the port is 21. You also have to give the FTP account username. *Folder* refers to the path of the folder where the backups should be kept. The path should be relative to the FTP directory which is allocated to you.
2. Click *Back Up Now* in the *Overview* tab. In the upcoming steps, give your FTP account password and the encryption password for the backup (Figures 4 and 5) and you're done!

I don't think there is a need to explain the restoration process. Just click the *Restore...* button in the *Overview* tab and follow the instructions.



Note: If you'd like to use a Web hosting account for FTP backup storage, it is recommended that you create a dedicated account for this purpose. This ensures better privacy, isolation and security.

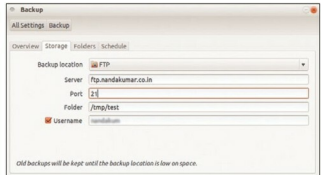


Figure 3: FTP settings



Figure 4: FTP password



Figure 5: FTP encryption password